

IT Helpdesk & IAM Home Lab — Simulation Scenarios

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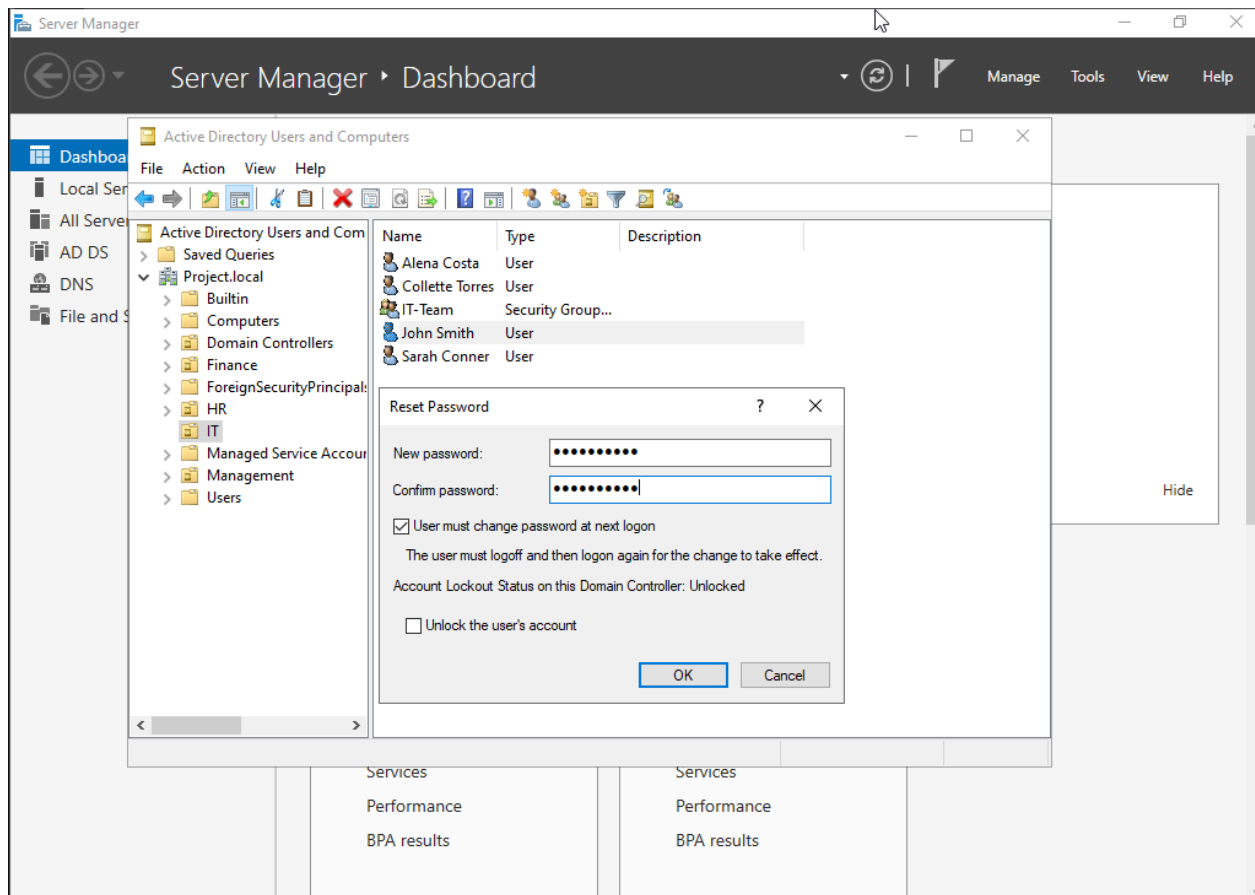
Overview

This section documents 6 real world scenarios I simulated directly inside my Active Directory environment. These scenarios cover the most common tasks handled by both Helpdesk technicians and IAM analysts in enterprise organizations. Each scenario was treated as a real ticket — with a request, a process and a resolution.

Scenario 1 — Password Reset (Helpdesk)

Ticket: User jsmith from the IT department forgot his password and was unable to log in. A password reset was requested.

This is one of the most frequent tickets any Helpdesk technician handles on a daily basis. I located jsmith in the IT Organizational Unit inside Active Directory Users and Computers, right clicked his account and selected Reset Password. I assigned a temporary password and enabled the "User must change password at next logon" option to ensure security compliance. The user was then able to log back in with the temporary password and set their own new one.

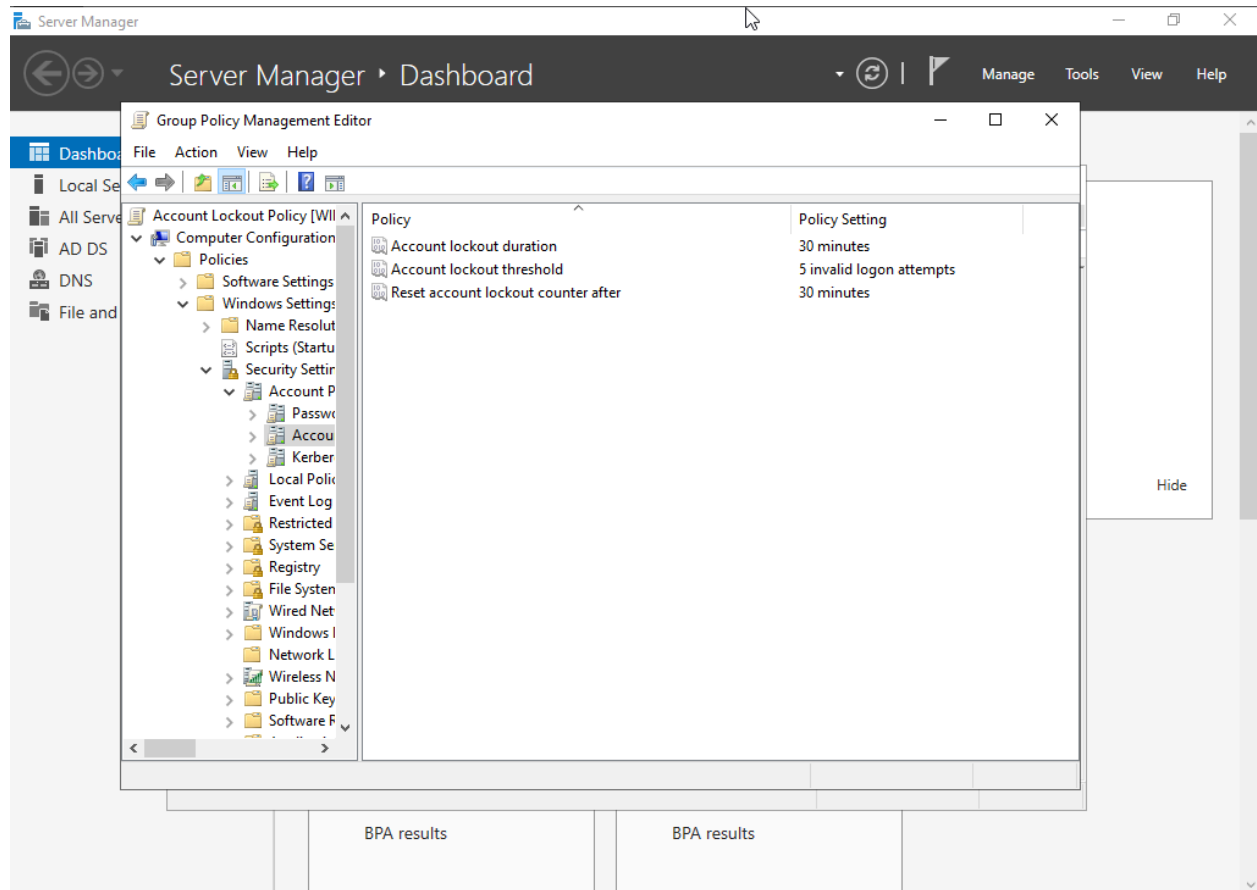


Scenario 2 — Account Lockout (Helpdesk)

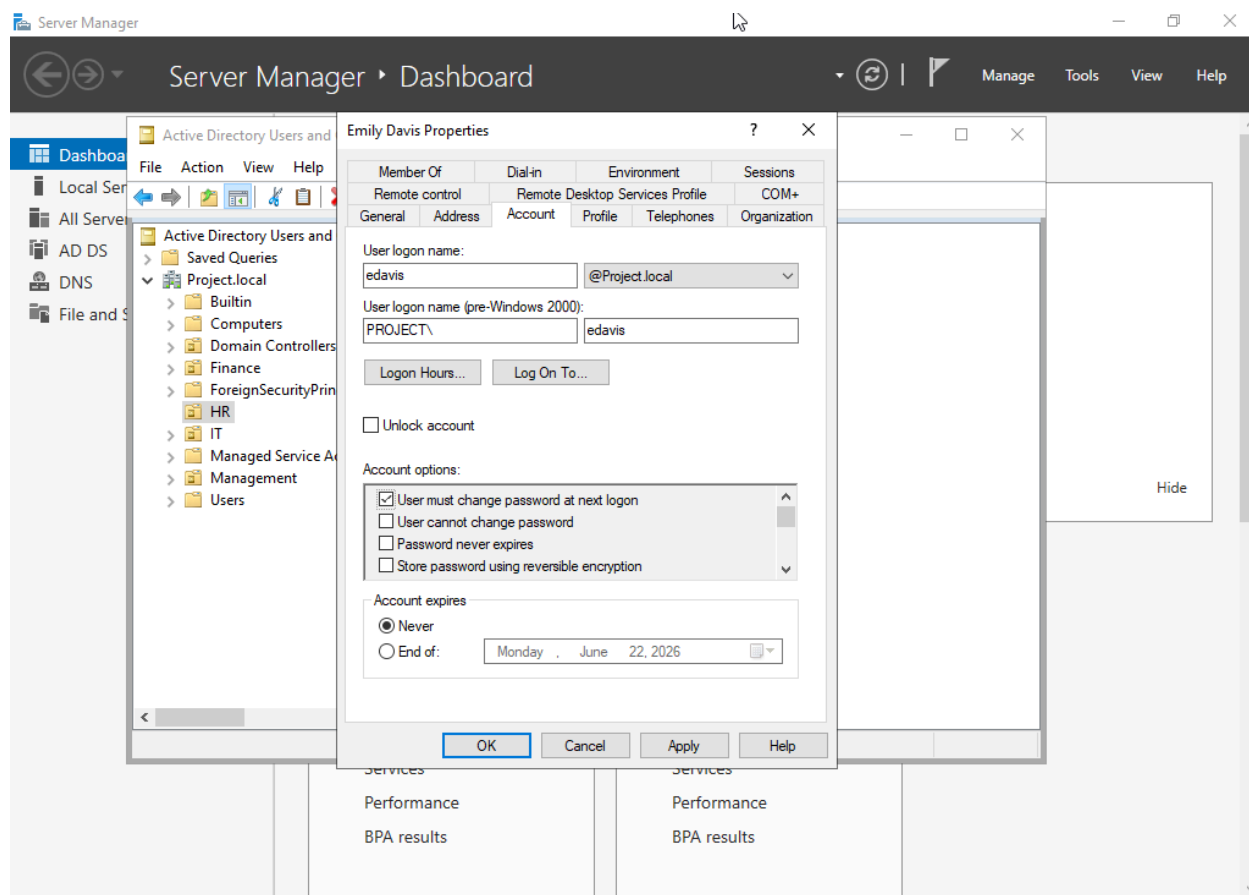
Ticket: User edavis from the HR department was locked out of her account after multiple failed login attempts.

Account lockouts are another extremely common Helpdesk scenario, often caused by forgotten passwords or cached credentials on old devices. Before resolving this ticket I first configured an Account Lockout Policy GPO at the domain level with the following settings:

- Account lockout threshold: 5 invalid attempts
- Account lockout duration: 30 minutes
- Reset account lockout counter after: 30 minutes



I then located edavis in the HR OU, opened her account properties and navigated to the Account tab to demonstrate the unlock process. In a real environment the "Unlock account" checkbox would be active and checked — unlocking it immediately restores the user's access.



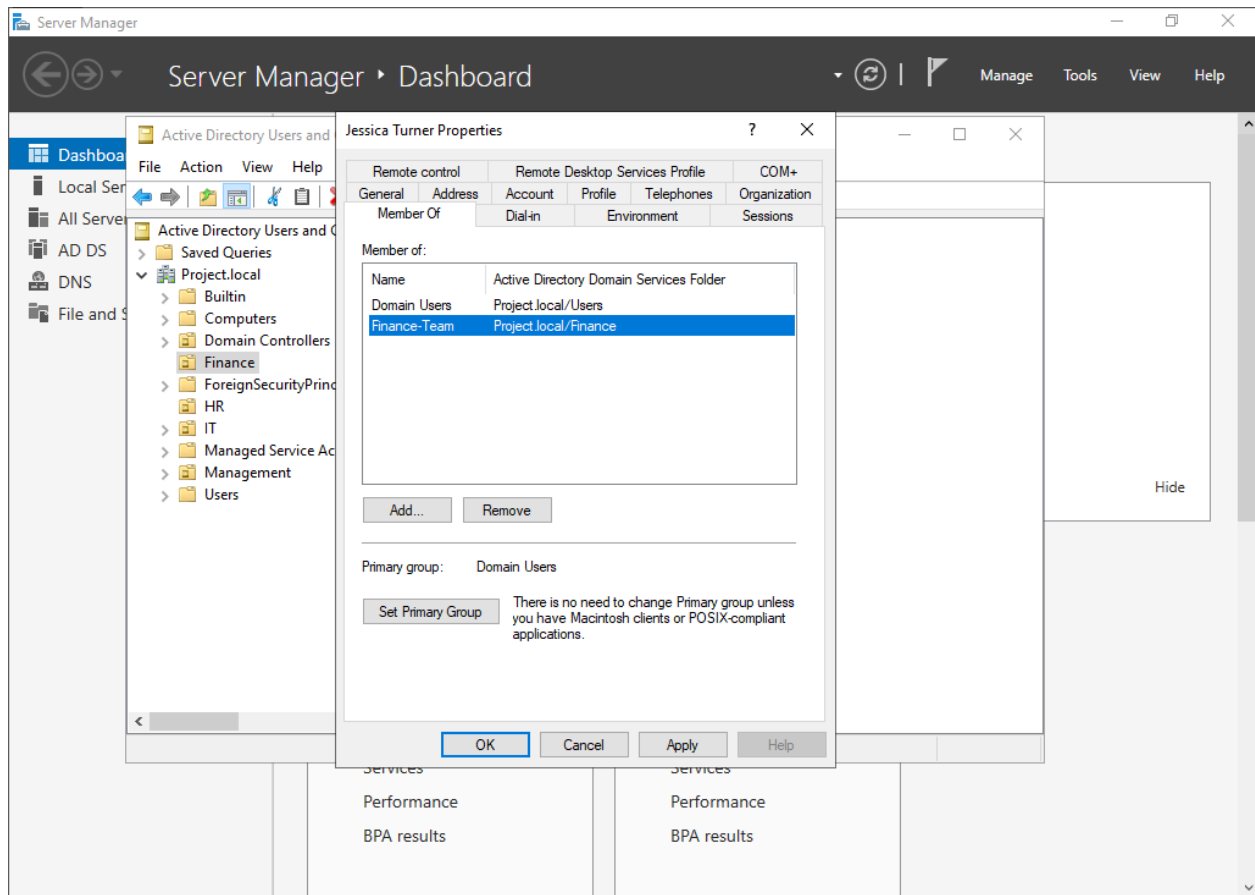
Scenario 3 — New Employee Onboarding — Joiner (IAM)

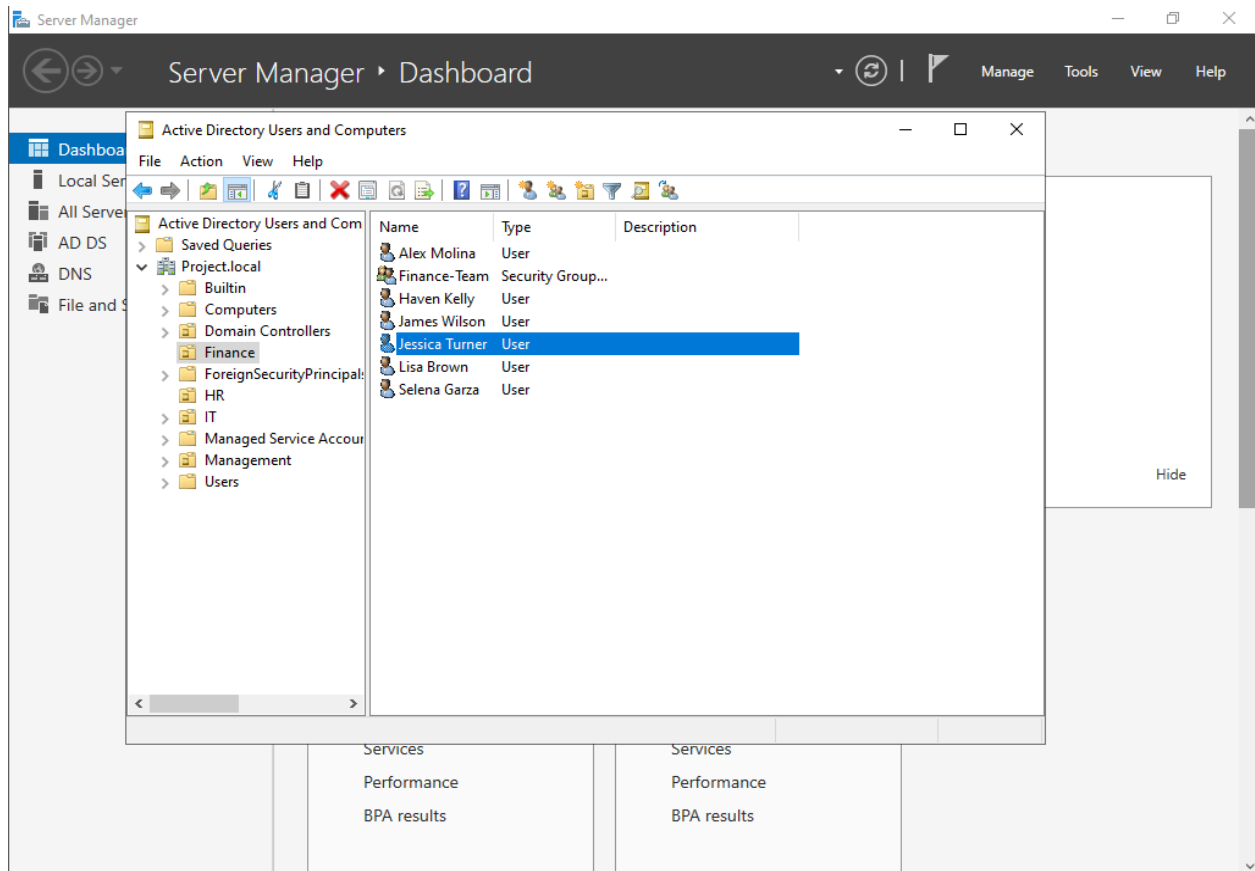
Ticket: A new employee Jessica Turner has joined the Finance department. Please create her account and assign appropriate access.

Onboarding is one of the core responsibilities of an IAM analyst. I created a new user account for Jessica Turner with the username jturner inside the Finance Organizational Unit. Her account was created with a temporary password and the "User must change password at next logon" option enabled — which is standard onboarding practice.

After creating the account I added jturner to the Finance-Team security group through her Member Of tab, ensuring she had access to all resources her department requires from day

one.



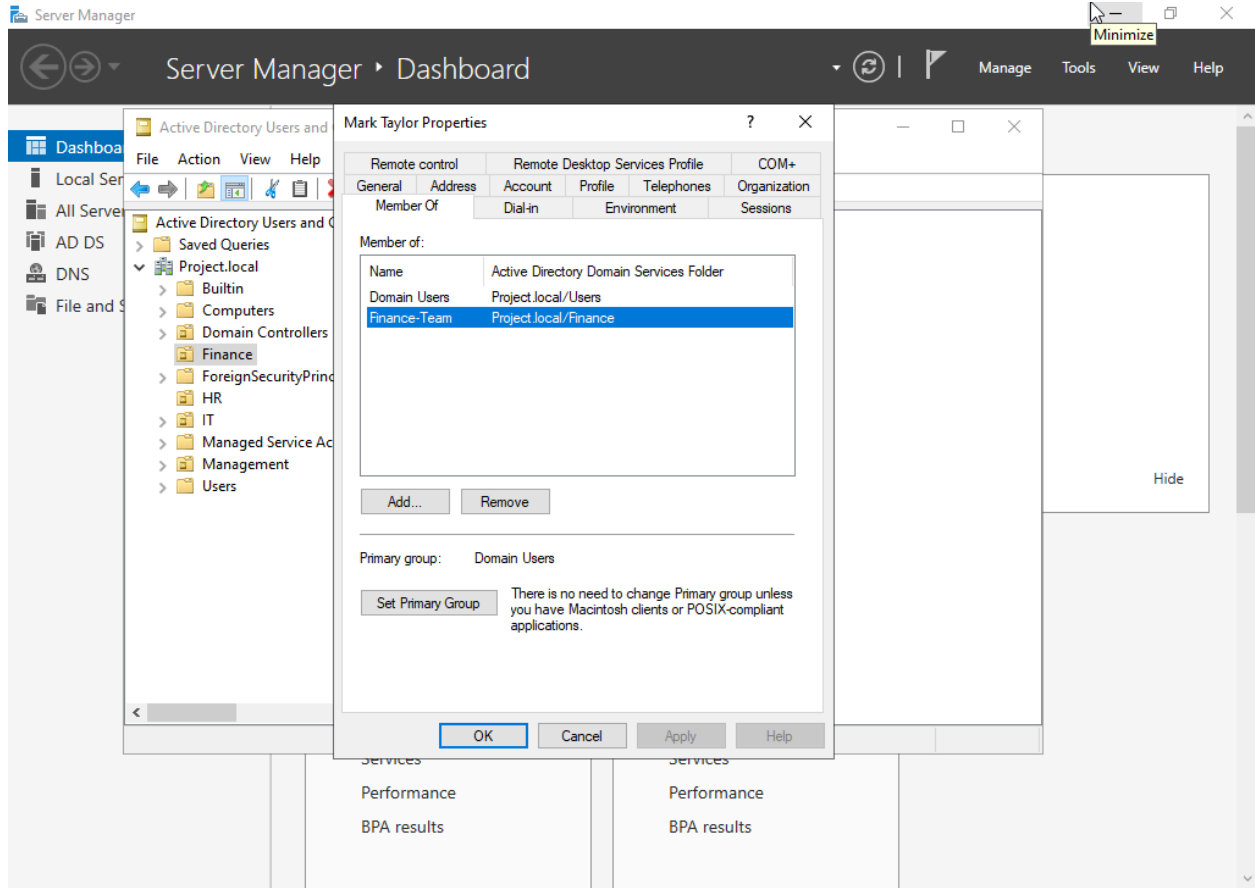


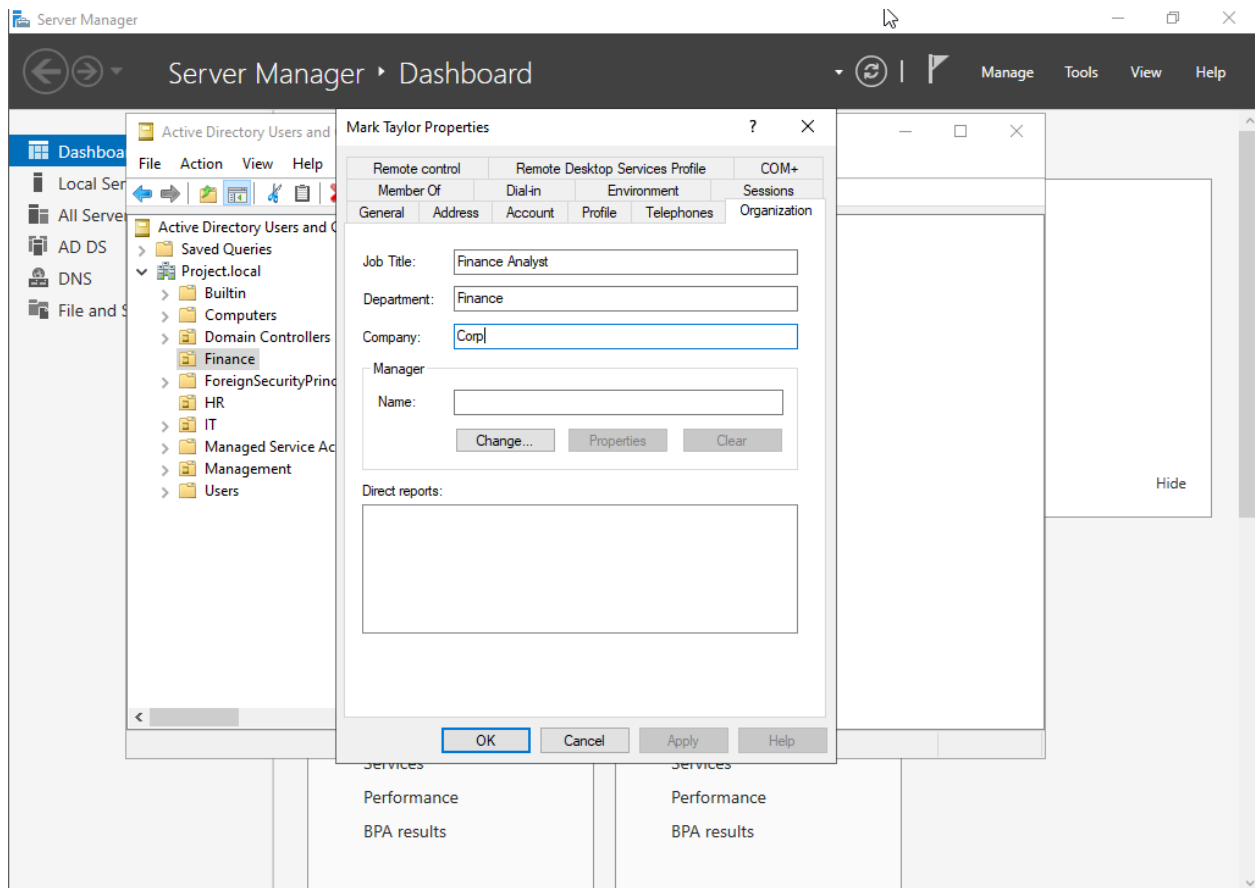
Scenario 4 — Employee Department Transfer — Mover (IAM)

Ticket: Employee Mark Taylor (mtaylor) has been transferred from HR to Finance. Please update his account accordingly.

When an employee moves departments their access profile needs to be updated immediately to reflect their new role. Leaving old access in place is a common security risk known as access creep. I handled this transfer in three steps:

First I moved mtaylor's account from the HR Organizational Unit to the Finance Organizational Unit using the Move function in Active Directory. Then I updated his security group memberships by removing him from HR-Team and adding him to Finance-Team. Finally I updated his Organization tab to reflect his new department as Finance and assigned an appropriate job title.



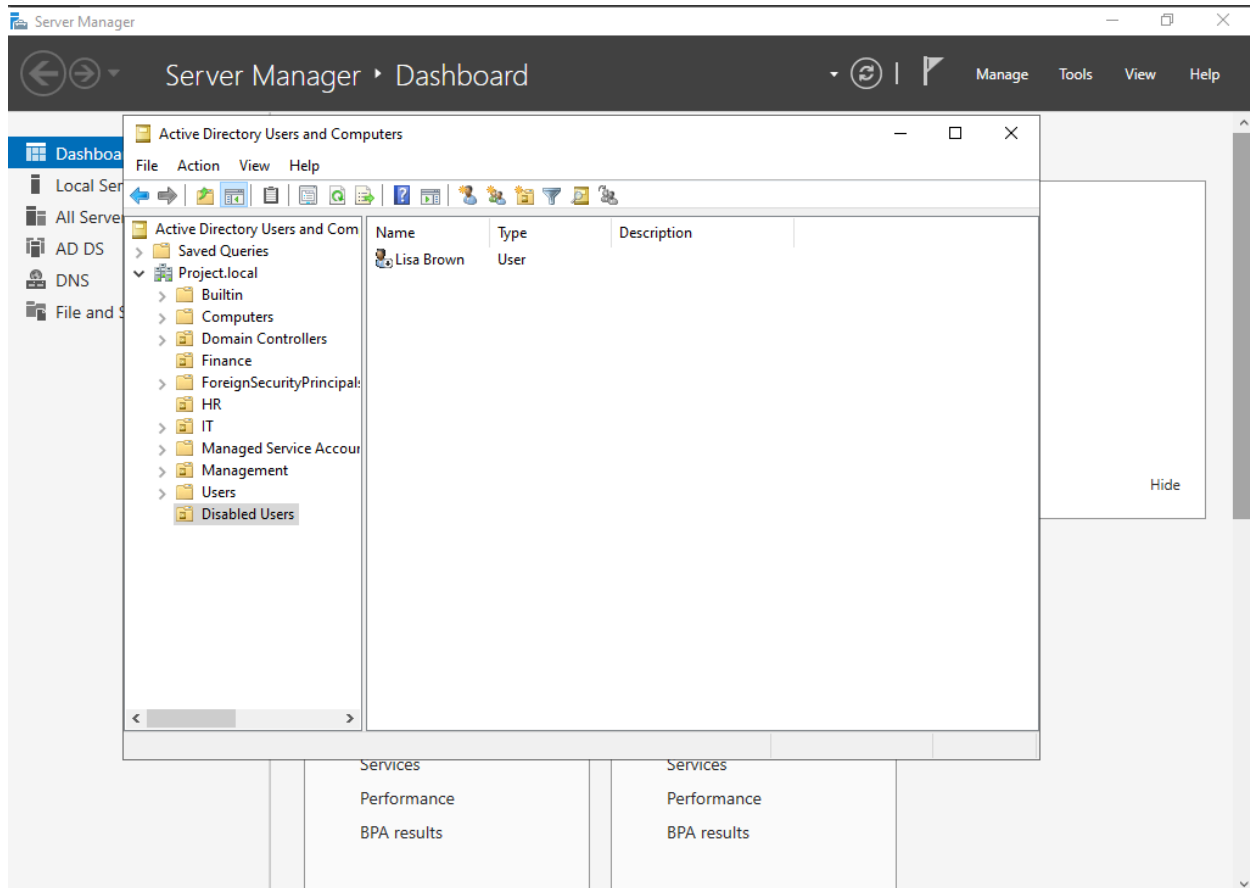


Scenario 5 — Employee Termination — Leaver (IAM)

Ticket: Employee Lisa Brown (lbrown) from Finance has left the company. Please disable her account and remove all access immediately.

Offboarding is one of the most critical IAM processes in any organization. Leaving an ex-employee's account active is a serious security risk. I followed a proper Leaver process for lbrown in three steps:

First I disabled her account by right clicking and selecting Disable Account in Active Directory — a disabled arrow icon immediately appeared on her account confirming it was inactive. Then I removed her from the Finance-Team security group through her Member Of tab, revoking all group based access. Finally I moved her account to a dedicated Disabled Users Organizational Unit to keep the directory clean and auditable while retaining her account record for compliance purposes.



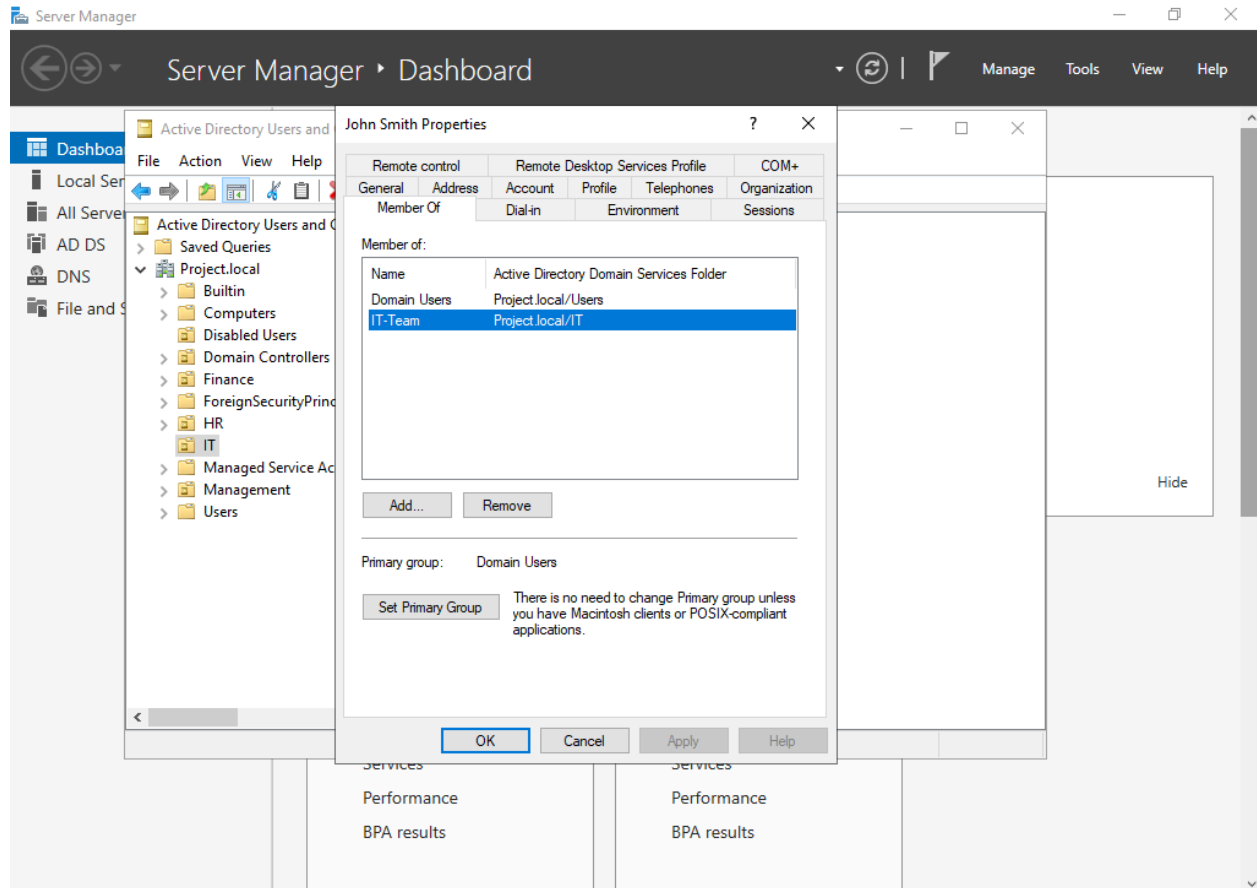
Scenario 6 — Quarterly Access Review (IAM)

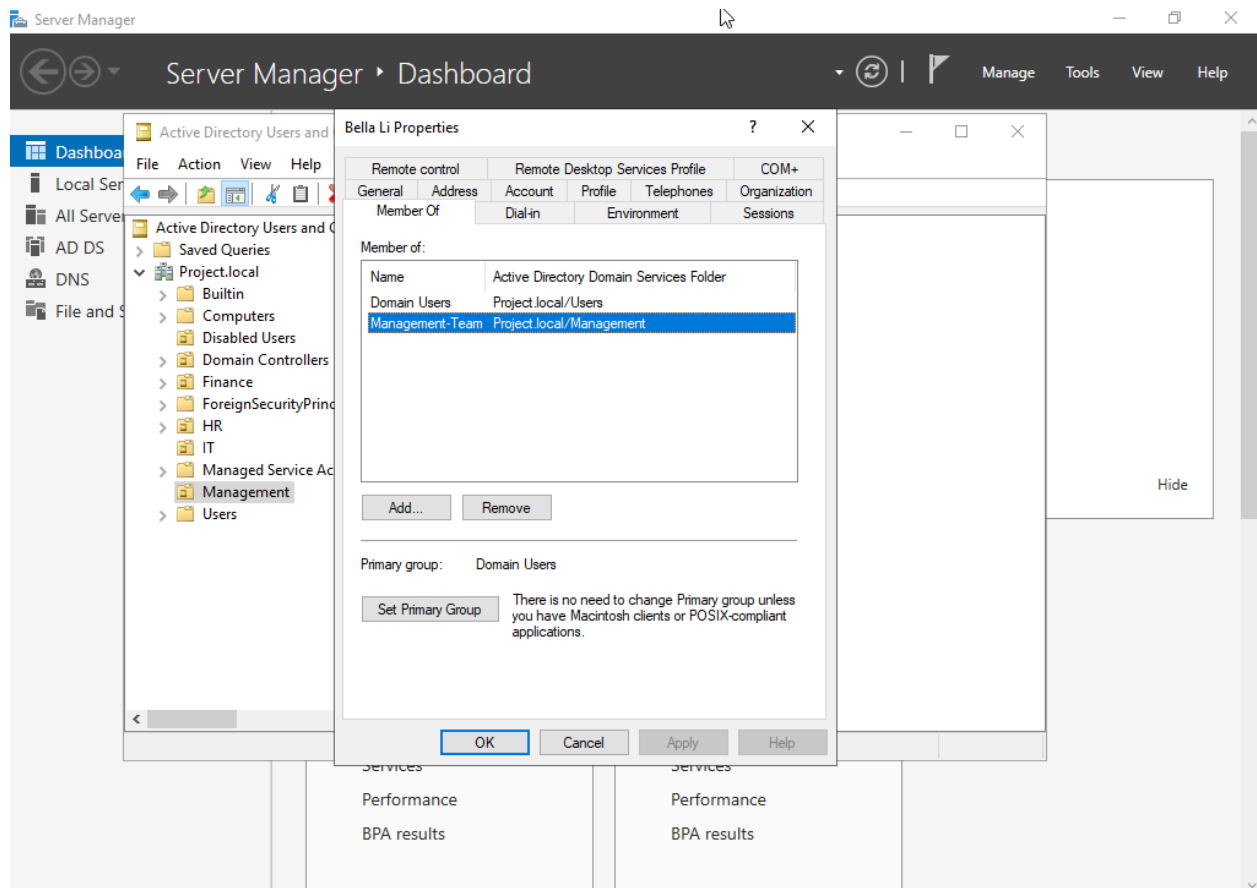
Ticket: Perform a quarterly access review of all department users and verify their group memberships are accurate and appropriate.

Access reviews are a fundamental IAM practice used to ensure users only have access to what they need — a principle known as Least Privilege. I reviewed all users across all four departments by checking each user's Member Of tab and verifying their group memberships matched their current department and role.

During this review the following access changes were identified and documented:

- **mtaylor** — Successfully transferred from HR to Finance. Group membership updated from HR-Team to Finance-Team. Organization details updated accordingly.
- **lbrown** — Account disabled following termination. Removed from Finance-Team. Account moved to Disabled Users OU.
- **jturner** — New employee onboarded to Finance department. Account created and added to Finance-Team with appropriate access.





All identified changes were legitimate and had corresponding tickets. No unauthorized access was found. Access review completed and documented.

Summary

These 6 scenarios demonstrate a full cycle of real world Helpdesk and IAM tasks performed inside a live Active Directory environment. From basic password resets to full employee lifecycle management — Joiner, Mover and Leaver — this simulation reflects the kind of work done daily in enterprise IT and identity security teams.